

CNC TRAY CAPTURE

one tool, about ninety seconds

1 SHEET

Take a trace sheet: the smallest size the tool lies in with a finger's width to spare. The size and its window are printed under the window. Write the tool's TAG (TO__, from the drawer label) in the TAG box.

2 HEIGHT

Slide the tool edge-on into the gauge. The smallest slot it enters is its height: 10, 20, 30, 40 or 50. Write it in the HEIGHT box.

3 LAY

Lay the tool inside the window, as it sits in the drawer. Clear of the border line and of the four corner squares.

4 TRACE

Pencil in the TRACE collar. Straight up like a candle, collar riding the tool. Trace the OUTSIDE only, all the way round, until the line meets itself.

5 PHOTO

Lift the tool off. Photograph the whole sheet from above: all four corner squares in frame, sheet flat, no shadow across the line.

6 FORM

Open the form "CNC tray capture": tag, height, photo. Done. The software reads the corner squares to know which paper you used. The tray regenerates; a rejected sheet comes back with one line saying why.

WHEN NOT TO TRACE

IT DOES NOT FIT THE WINDOW

Take a bigger sheet: LETTER, A4, TABLOID, A3, ARCH B, A2. Remember the pencil rides 7mm outside the tool, so leave 10mm of clear paper all round. If the tool is a plain rectangular slab, do not trace it at all: write L, W and thickness in the boxes and photograph the sheet.

IT HAS A SLOT, THROAT OR GAP UNDER 20mm

The collar is 14mm across and cannot enter one, so the line bridges it and the pocket comes out solid there. Caliper that one dimension and write it on the sheet beside the boxes.

One tool per sheet. Never a hand in the window, never a tool on its edge, never a tool that moved.

Sheets, collar, pencil and gauge live in Drawer 1. Print at 100%: the bar at the bottom must measure 100mm.